Sindh ethnic grievances are known to be high as well. This is largely reflected in Figure 1.2, which captures data from 2009 (although there is enough anger felt by Punjabis as well). These frustrations were also reflected in data from the focus groups conducted in 2014–15.

The privileged elite

In examining the nature of the ruling elite in Pakistan and their influence on the state, Rais (2017) expands on LaPorte's argument illustrating how an 'elite' group comprised of high-level military and 'central administrative' officers and big landlords and their families from across the country has dominated politics in Pakistan. It was this relationship between the army and the bureaucracy that further weakened political institutions of the country (2017). Hussain (2018) in his work presents a 'model of an elitist economy' (1999) that comprised '1–2 per cent of the population' that enjoyed 'accumulation of wealth amidst widespread poverty and squalor'. In highlighting this inequality he argues that 'the state, which has to ensure equitable distribution of gains of economic growth, is also controlled by the same elite who evade taxes and appropriate the public expenditure for their own benefits' (p. 17). The study participants were aware of this corruption, which was often associated with the state and the elite who had privileges because of their socio-economic status.

> *In my view, rich people are less aware of their rights and duties as compared to poor because rich look down upon the poor and do not perform their duties. Rich are given preference in our society. For instance, if a rich [person] indulges into a wrongdoing he can easily escape from the punishment with the power of money. Poor are punished for what they have never done. This difference is causing deterioration in the society.*
>
> (Student, Female, Hub)

The increasing gap between the rich and poor and the resulting class differences also contributes to an increased sense of alienation. Poverty is a real problem as the elites are seen to benefit from the system while no one ensures that the poor get a better life: '*In my view, the concept of citizenship in Pakistan among the "high" class is living in luxury with lots of servants around*' (Teacher, Female, Karachi); '*When the people have enough to eat then come to me and ask about citizenship*' (Focus Group, Private University[20]); '*The rich do not consider their or anyone else's rights seriously. Because they are rich they are more individualistic, they have an attitude of being unconcerned about most of the things around them. In addition to it, nobody really criticizes them for that too*' (Madrassa Student, Male, Islamabad).